

317 NEWS LETTER

— ISN'T 3 THE LUCKY NUMBER? —

TEAMWORK

LEADERSHIP

ADVENTURE



INSPIRING YOUNG PEOPLE
TO SOAR HIGH

INSIDE THIS ISSUE



Athletics
PAGE 02

Wing Skills Week
PAGE 03

AEF Flying
PAGE 04

North Region Band
PAGE 05

Silver DofE Final
PAGE 06



NEW ATHLETES INCOMING!

Chasing Glory: 317 Squadron Heads to
Wing Athletics

TAKE A PEEK
INTO 317
ATHLETICS



SCAN me!!



WHO ARE THEY?

One of the best parts of Wing Athletics isn't just the medals or the bragging rights—it's spotting all the new faces. Every year you walk onto the track expecting to see the usual suspects, only to realise half the squad looks like they've just wandered in from First Class training... and somehow they're already outrunning everyone else.

As new cadets join the RAFAC, a new generation of talent joins with them, ready to carry on the legacy built not only by 317 Squadron but by the wider Wing. It's a strange feeling watching familiar names disappear from the results sheet, only for new ones to appear almost overnight.

Before you know it, the cadet you helped teach how to stand at ease is flying past you in the 1500 metres, making you question both your fitness and your life choices. That's the beauty of Wing Athletics—records may be broken, teams may change, but the tradition never stops. The faces are different, the speed somehow gets faster every year, and the legacy continues, one exhausted finish line at a time.

SHINY THINGS WE BROUGHT HOME

- **GOLD: 1**
- **SILVER: 0**
- **BRONZE: 2**



WING SKILLS WEEK

Throughout the week, cadets from across the Wing came together to take part in Wing Skills Week—an action-packed programme designed to develop practical skills, leadership, and teamwork. With a wide range of activities on offer, cadets had the opportunity to step outside their comfort zones, learn something new, and build on existing knowledge.



WING ADVENTURES



For many cadets, Wing Skills Week is their first experience of an overnight camp after completing their passing out parade—and with that comes the terrifying realisation that you actually have to talk to people from other squadrons. Walking into a room full of strangers can feel daunting, and for the first few hours everyone seems to cling to the one person they vaguely recognise.

But somewhere between the icebreakers, shared challenges, and debating whose squadron does drill "properly," those awkward introductions turn into genuine friendships. Before you know it, you've found your Wing crew—the people you'll bump into at every camp, competition, and course for the rest of your cadet career. Wing Skills Week isn't just where you learn new skills; it's where complete strangers somehow become the friends who'll be cheering you on, winding you up, and making every future event that little bit more memorable.

THE CLOSEST THING TO TOP GUN

THE AIR EXPERIENCE FLYING

AIR EXPERIENCE FLYING

Air Experience Flying is more than just flying. Before taking to the skies, cadets learn essential flight procedures, aircraft safety, and how RAF stations operate. Flying from RAF stations such as **RAF Wittering, RAF Leeming, RAF Cranwell, RAF Benson, RAF Cosford, RAF Shawbury, and RAF Woodvale**, cadets gain a valuable insight into military aviation while experiencing life on an active RAF base.

WINGS IN THE MAKING

Air Experience Flying (AEF) is one of the most sought-after activities in the RAF Air Cadets, with some squadrons waiting months—or even years—for the chance to get airborne. Thankfully, 317 Squadron continues to give our cadets opportunities to swap parade shoes for a cockpit. Whether it was a first flight or another excuse to remind everyone they've actually flown an aircraft, AEF offered an unforgettable experience, incredible views, and just enough turbulence to keep things interesting. It's safe to say there were plenty of smiles on landing—and only a few disappointed that they weren't allowed to take the aircraft home.



IN THE TRENCHES



317 SQN TAKES ON SLIVER DOFE, AGAIN...

After arriving at the campsite, a few cadets attempted to fly a kite... with absolutely no success.

For Air Cadets, it wasn't exactly our finest aviation achievement. It's probably safe to say a few of them will need to resit their Principles of Flight lesson—and perhaps hand in their Classification Badge until further notice!

Getting lost in a field of cows: **10-12 times... per group**

Enjoying all 4 seasons packed into a day: **2**

Bonding over the amount of km until the campsite is on the horizon: **∞**

Group 2 made such good progress that they arrived back earlier than expected. While most people would see that as a success, it meant they hadn't been out for the minimum time required to complete the expedition. As a result, they had to head back out and walk an extra 2.5 km before they could officially finish. Although it wasn't quite the ending they had in mind, a well-earned ice cream at the finish line helped make up for the unexpected detour.

Despite this triumphant moment, our campsite came with an unexpected view this year, as multiple wildfires could be seen burning across the surrounding hills. It certainly wasn't the scenery we expected, but it made for a memorable expedition!